Teething biscuits & finger snacks: HMTc Standard

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CORRESPONDENCE

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KEYWORDS

heavy metals, food safety, dietary exposure

PUBLICATION HISTORY

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Abstract

The Heavy Metal Tested & Certified standard for teething biscuits and dry finger snacks for infants and young children, stated as-sold. Rice-based products carry a distinct inorganic-arsenic limit. Every limit is the strictest maximum level any credible government sets, converted to the as-sold basis, with read-across where no government regulates the exact product.

1 | How every number on this standard is set

HMTc Method v2.0 (government-limit default, 8:1 basis, read-across)

2 | Master limit table

All values in ppb (µg/kg), as sold basis. A brand meeting every value qualifies for the mark.

Variants on this standard: rice-based and non-rice. Where a cell differs between them the limit column shows both (value per variant); the derivation below is stated for rice-based.

ANALYTE	TIER	HMTC LIMIT	BASIS
Lead (Pb)	Tier 1	20	government maximum level
Cadmium (Cd)	Tier 1	40	government maximum level
Total arsenic (tAs)	Tier 2	50	government maximum level

Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	Tier 1	20	human-grade read-across (European Union)
Mercury, total (tHg)	Tier 1	8	human-grade read-across (Israel)
Methylmercury (MeHg)	Tier 1	—	not compiled
Nickel (Ni)	Tier 2	3,000	government maximum level
Tin (Sn)	Tier 2	5,000	government maximum level
Aluminium (Al)	Tier 2	500	human-grade read-across (Australia / New Zealand)
Total chromium (Cr)	Tier 2	1,000	human-grade read-across (China)
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	Tier 2	—	not compiled

3 | Derivation — where each number comes from

Every cell traces to one named sovereign maximum level (the strictest for the nearest analog), or to an explicit control, not-material, or species-bounded determination. No occurrence statistic selects a certification value.

ANALYTE	HMTC	SOVEREIGN ANALOG / DETERMINATION
Lead (Pb)	20	government maximum level
Cadmium (Cd)	40	government maximum level
Total arsenic (tAs)	50	government maximum level
Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	20	European Union — human-food analog
Mercury, total (tHg)	8	Israel — human-food analog
Methylmercury (MeHg)	—	not compiled
Nickel (Ni)	3,000	government maximum level
Tin (Sn)	5,000	government maximum level
Aluminium (Al)	500	Australia / New Zealand — human-food analog
Total chromium (Cr)	1,000	China — human-food analog
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	—	not compiled

4 | Cite this standard

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References

[1] Australia / New Zealand — human-food maximum levels
Binds Al. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[2] China — human-food maximum levels
Binds Cr. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[3] European Union — human-food maximum levels
Binds iAs. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[4] Israel — human-food maximum levels
Binds tHg. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

STATUS AND LICENCE

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COMPETING INTERESTS

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DATA AVAILABILITY

The works this reference draws on are listed in full in the references above and on the briefing page at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/teething-and--snacks. Primary legal instruments and expert-body assessments are named with their public identifiers; the underlying occurrence and toxicology corpus is maintained on the Heavy Metal Index.

PUBLICATION HISTORY

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